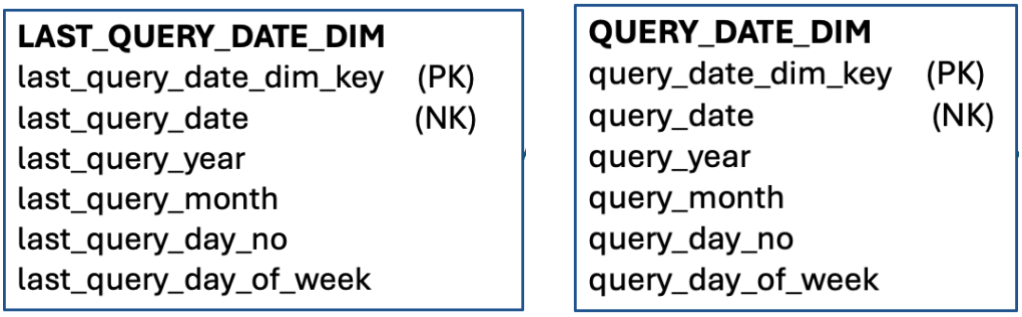
Role Play DATE_DIM recipe(s)

I would suggest using role play views for any data dimensions in your data model. You can use the delivered DIM_DATE table as the source for the data. You will notice there are a ton of columns in the DIM_DATE table and most don't really make any sense for our project. Through the role play view, WhereScape Dimension View, we can change names for the view and column names, but also reduce the number of columns to only those that make sense for this project. Two potential date dimension views I came up with are: query_date_dim and last_query_date_dim. Name your date dimensions whatever you like, here are the steps for creating one.



Column mappings to DIM_DATE:

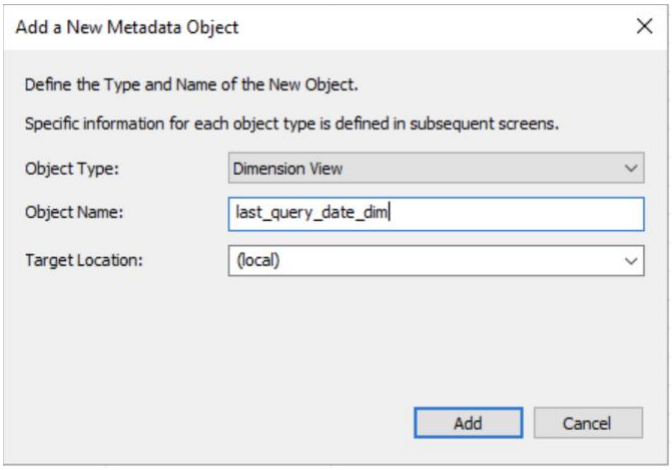
After looking at the dim_date data, I chose the following columns to include in my date dimension views:

Calendar_date (NK)
Cal_year
Cal_month_no
Cal_day_in_month
Cal_day_in_week

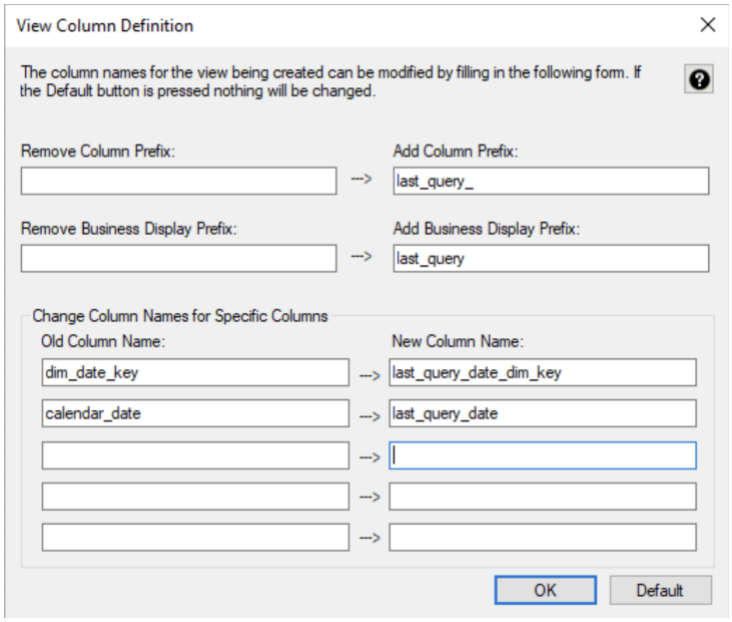
Note that this is an extremely simplified data dimensions, but given we don't have any complex date related requirements, this will be good enough for a proof of concept.

1) In left pane, double click on "Dimension View" to make Dimension View the focus of the middle pane. *Note that if you do not see "Dimension View" as an object type, you should see the document "Setting up WhereScape Repository", the end of the document covers how to enable "Dimension View" object type*.
2) In right pane, open your data warehouse connection, if not already open.

3) In right pane, select dim_date and drag to the middle pane.
4) In the “Add a New Metadata Object” screen, rename view to “last_query_date_dim”, then click Add.



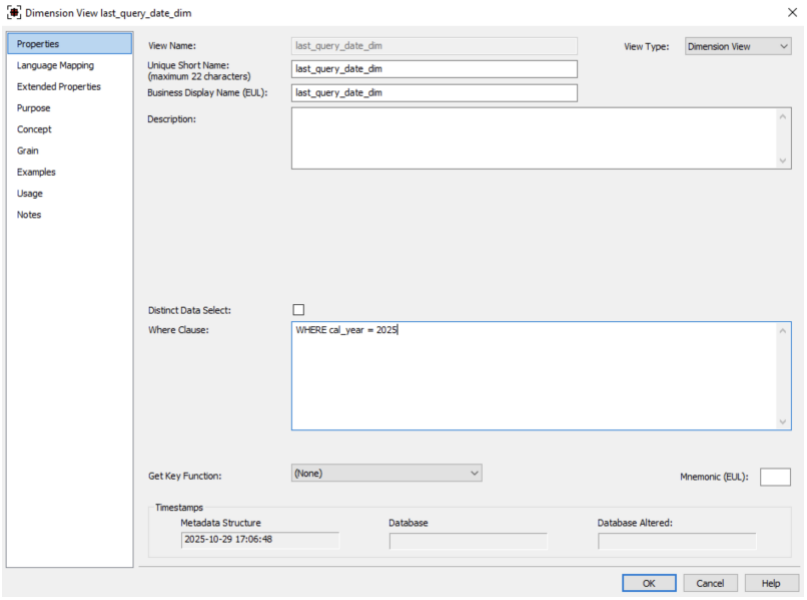
5) In the “View Column Definition” screen, rename “calendar_date” to “last_query_date” to match the data model. See screenshot below.



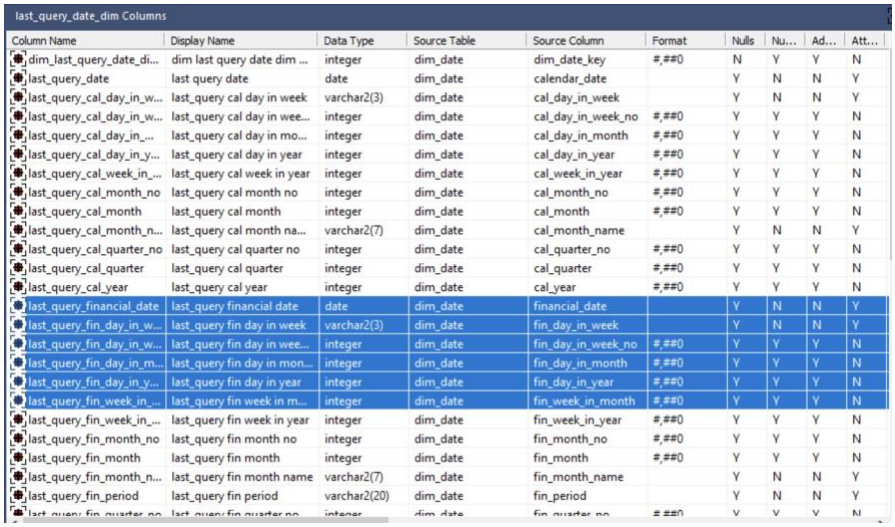
6) Click OK.
7) In the “Dimension View last_query_date” screen, paste the following code in the Where Clause code box:
WHERE cal_year = 2025

See screenshot below.

Role Play DATE_DIM recipe(s)

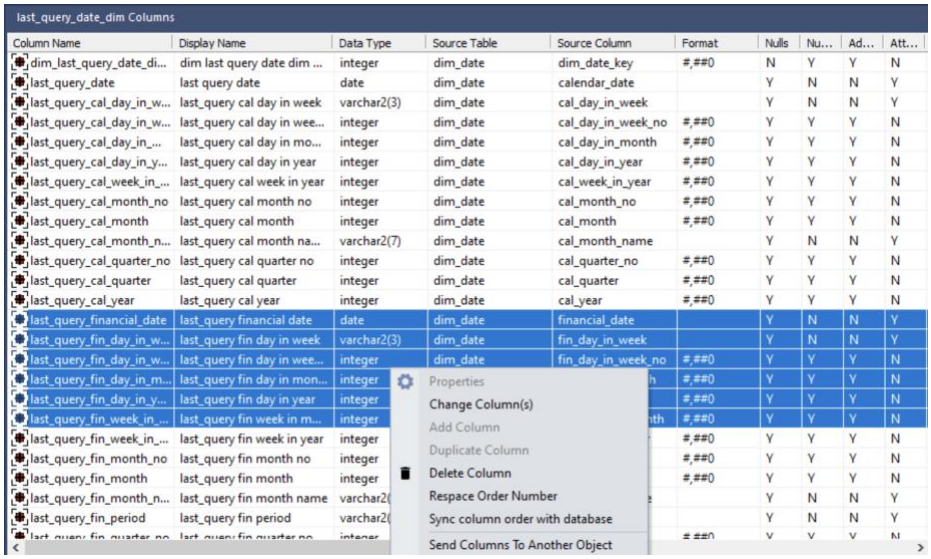


8) Click OK.
9) For the “Create Database View” screen, click “Close”.
10) You now have a view definition containing many columns you don’t want. You will begin to drop the unwanted columns in ranges. For example, click on “last_query_financial_date” column, hold down the control key and click on more columns, below the “last_query_financial_date”. You will then have multiple columns highlighted.



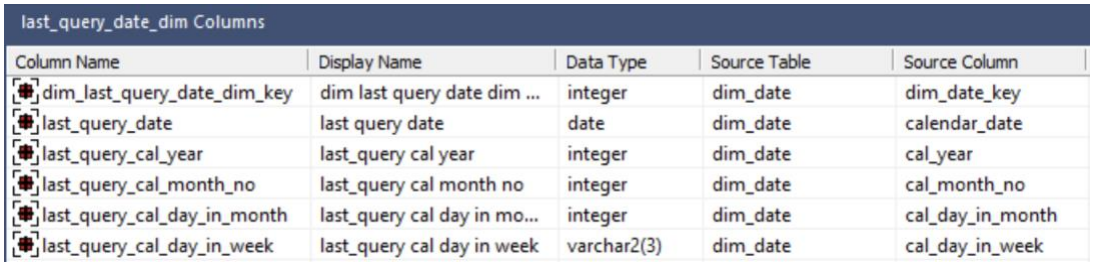
Column Name	Display Name	Data Type	Source Table	Source Column	Format	Nulls	Nu...	Ad...	Att...
dim_last_query_date_di...	dim last query date dim ...	integer	dim_date	dim_date_key	#,##0	N	Y	Y	N
last_query_date	last query date	date	dim_date	calendar_date		Y	N	N	Y
last_query_cal_day_in_w...	last query cal day in week	varchar2(3)	dim_date	cal_day_in_week		Y	N	N	Y
last_query_cal_day_in_w...	last query cal day in wee...	integer	dim_date	cal_day_in_week_no	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_day_in_...	last query cal day in mo...	integer	dim_date	cal_day_in_month	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_day_in_y...	last query cal day in year	integer	dim_date	cal_day_in_year	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_week_in_...	last query cal week in year	integer	dim_date	cal_week_in_year	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_month_no	last query cal month no	integer	dim_date	cal_month_no	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_month	last query cal month	integer	dim_date	cal_month	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_month_n...	last query cal month na...	varchar2(7)	dim_date	cal_month_name		Y	N	N	Y
last_query_cal_quarter_no	last query cal quarter no	integer	dim_date	cal_quarter_no	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_quarter	last query cal quarter	integer	dim_date	cal_quarter	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_cal_year	last query cal year	integer	dim_date	cal_year	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_financial_date	last query financial date	date	dim_date	financial_date		Y	N	N	Y
last_query_fin_day_in_w...	last query fin day in week	varchar2(3)	dim_date	fin_day_in_week		Y	N	N	Y
last_query_fin_day_in_w...	last query fin day in wee...	integer	dim_date	fin_day_in_week_no	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_day_in_m...	last query fin day in mon...	integer	dim_date	fin_day_in_month	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_day_in_y...	last query fin day in year	integer	dim_date	fin_day_in_year	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_week_in_...	last query fin week in m...	integer	dim_date	fin_week_in_month	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_week_in_...	last query fin week in year	integer	dim_date	fin_week_in_year	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_month_no	last query fin month no	integer	dim_date	fin_month_no	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_month	last query fin month	integer	dim_date	fin_month	#,##0	Y	Y	Y	N
last_query_fin_month_n...	last query fin month name	varchar2(7)	dim_date	fin_month_name		Y	N	N	Y
last_query_fin_period	last query fin period	varchar2(20)	dim_date	fin_period		Y	N	N	Y

Right click on one of the highlighted columns and select “Delete column”.



11) You will receive a confirmation “Continue to delete X columns?”, click Yes.
12) Repeat this process to delete, all but the columns you wish to keep. For me it is:
    Last_query_date_dim_key (PK)
    Last_query_date (NK)
    Last_query_Cal_year
    Last_query_Cal_month_no
    Last_query_Cal_day_in_month
    Last_query_Cal_day_in_week

13) Note that I also moved the columns in WhereScape to match the order of the columns in my data model. See screenshot below for results.



14) I still have some column renaming to do, in order to make this dimension view match my data model. Rename the following columns:
    Last_query_cal_year to last_query_year
    Last_query_cal_month_no to last_query_month
    Last_query_cal_day_in_month to last_query_day_no
    Last_query_cal_in_week to last_query_day_of_week

After renaming columns, should look like this screenshot.

last_query_date_dim Columns

Column Name	Display Name	Data Type	Source Table	Source Column
dim_last_query_date_di...	dim last query ...	integer	dim_date	dim_date_key
last_query_date	last query date	date	dim_date	calendar_date
last_query_year	last_query year	integer	dim_date	cal_year
last_query_month	last_query mo...	integer	dim_date	cal_month_no
last_query_day_no	last_query day ...	integer	dim_date	cal_day_in_month
last_query_day_of_week	last_query day ...	varchar2(3)	dim_date	cal_day_in_week

15) In left pane, right click last_query_date, then select “create(replace)”.
16) In left pane, right click last_query_date, then select “code > rebuild get key procedure”.
17) For the “last_query_date update build options”, simply click OK.
18) In left pane, right click last_query_date, then select “display data”. How does your data look?

Data display for team_jeff.last_query_date_dim

DIM_LAST_...	LAST_QUE...	LAST_QUE...	LAST_QUE...	LAST_QUE...	LAST_QUE...
20250101	2025-01-01...	2025	1	1	WED
20250103	2025-01-03...	2025	1	3	FRI
20250104	2025-01-04...	2025	1	4	SAT
20250106	2025-01-06...	2025	1	6	MON
20250107	2025-01-07...	2025	1	7	TUE
20250108	2025-01-08...	2025	1	8	WED
20250109	2025-01-09	2025	1	9	THU

You can follow these steps to create query_date_dim, snapshot_date_dim, etc. Simply replace the names.